DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

Leviticus 11:4 — the verse that condemns the substitute

Jev score: 0.47 — illumination rating of Leviticus 11:4, highest of 10 sources tested; none crossed 0.5

The daf's baraita needs a verse to prove that the substitute of a disqualified consecrated animal must die — and it finds one hiding in the purity laws. Leviticus 11:4's extraneous phrase, "it is impure to you," flags an animal that carries every sign of kosher and still may not be eaten: the substitute. Jev rated this source 0.47 — the most illuminating of the ten tested, but a moderate score, not a decisive one.

What is non-obvious is the move itself: a verse about cud-chewing and split hooves becomes the legal anchor for sacrificial substitution, and the Gemara then has to fight off rival claimants to the same phrase — the five sin offerings left to die, the guilt-offering's substitute — triangulating the verse against the halakha leMoshe miSinai until both turn out to be necessary, one teaching the category, the other the method.

Rejected by Jev: Maharam, Lemberg ed. 312 (0.42), the tractate introduction (0.27), Be'er Yitzchak YD 27 (0.22), Leviticus 11:14 (0.17), Shoel uMeshiv IV 2:191 (0.13), Maharsham I 192:7 (0.08), Rivash 100:2 (0.08), Sha'agat Aryeh, Hagahot Asher 9 (0.07), Rivash 21:3 (0.05).

PARSHA · BERESHIT

Separation is the first creative act

Jev score: 0.51 — strongest of six candidate parsha connections; below the bar for a strong link

Bereshit opens with a God who divides: He separates the light from the darkness (1:4) and seals the division with "it was good"; the waters above are parted from the waters below. Bekhorot 16 does the same work in the register of law, sorting consecrated animals into destinies — redeemable, eaten blemished, or left to die. Jev gave this connection 0.51, the best of six candidates but short of the 0.6 bar for a strong link. The resonance is structural rather than textual: both texts sort their worlds by acts of division, yet the daf never cites Bereshit, and the parsha's separations create while the daf's condemn.

Rejected by Jev: holiness conferred by declaration (0.45), Adam naming the animals (0.41), the generations of Adam (0.36), the death decree (0.26), the first food laws (0.20).

NEWS CHECK

No genuine connection — and that's the finding

Jev score: 0.36 — highest of eight stories tested; below the bar, reported honestly

Eight of the week's biggest stories went through the blind test — the Flydubai cockpit attack, the third US carrier group steaming toward Iran, the completed Iraq withdrawal, the G7's

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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100-million-barrel reserve release, the Skydance merger, Russia's assault on Kyiv's grid, the Marshall Islands nuclear legacy, the UNGA walkout. Jev was unmoved: seven scored 0.13 or below. The best candidate, at 0.36, paired the Marshallese generations carrying radiation harm with the daf's dispute over how many generations a legal status travels — a genuine structural echo, but not a meaningful resonance. Some mornings the daf simply keeps its own counsel.

MAAGARIM · TEMURAH

תמורה: 1,437 attestations, from Temple swap to the word for change

תמורה is first seen in Leviticus 27:10, in the law of the swap that backfires: a man tries to exchange his consecrated animal for a better one — לא יחליפנו ולאימיר אתו — and the Torah answers that both animals stay holy: והיההוא ותמורתו יהיהקדש. Maagarim gives the word 1,437 attestations across 47 pages: a biblical halakhic core (Leviticus, Job 15:31, Ruth), then a dense Mishnaic and Talmudic cluster — Pesachim, Menachot, Chullin, Bekhorot itself — where the rabbis worked out exactly what this daf is working out. It surfaces in the medieval grammatical work ספר הרקמה (1171), then lands transformed in the 1920s and 30s: socialist journalism, Bialik's Don Quixote (1923), Shami's נקמת האבות (1927), Bialik's own prose (1930–32) — 'ימים ללא כלתמורה וחליפות,' days without any change. From a Temple regulation to the modern Hebrew word for change itself.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — *the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.*

GOV.IL ·

The government on this week's learning

What the State of Israel's own publications have to say about today's daf and parsha.

בקשה לקבלת היתר למכירת בכורות בקר או צאן

הרבנות הראשית לישראל · **gov.il**

Bekhorot 16's sugya — firstborn animals, blemishes, sale and redemption — is alive today as a Rabbinate-run permit system, with central sales erev Pesach and monthly Rosh Chodesh sales for cattle and sheep farmers.

https://www.gov.il/he/service/permit-to-sell-the-firstborns-of-cattle-or-sheep

כרך א, ביכורי גושן'

בתי הדין הרבניים · **gov.il**

Torah essays on the weekly parshiyot hosted on a government domain — the standing precedent for parsha content from the state's rabbinical courts.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/legalinfo/bikureigoshen1/he/BikkureiGoshen1.pdf

NLI ·

From the National Library

ויאמר אלקים יהי אור — the first words God speaks (Gen 1:3, in this very aliyah) — became a stock phrase for inauguration and renewal in modern Hebrew: building dedications, new institutions, communal ceremonies. The National Library's archive of the Dalia Dance Festival — the mass folk-dance gatherings of the Kibbutz movement in the 1940s–50s — preserves a musical number literally titled "יהי אור!", its lyrics and score handwritten in white ink on black paper, using the verse as the festival's own opening flourish.

יהי אור! — words and music for "Let there be light!" · Dalia Dance Festival Archive (Kibbutz Dalia)
https://www.nli.org.il/en/archives/NNL_ARCHIVE_AL997007821365105171

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 1

Genesis 1:1-2:3

The practice is shnayim mikra ve'echad targum: each verse of the day's aliyah read twice in Hebrew, then once in Targum Onkelos. Today's portion opens the Torah itself — the seven days of creation, from "In the beginning" to the blessing and sanctification of the seventh day.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 1:1 · ×2

בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹקִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ׃
בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹקִים אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ׃
בְּקַדְמִין בְּרָא יְיָ יָת שְׁמַיָּא וְיָת אַרְעָא׃

אלקים

Word study · first seen here

Klein: “God (pl. of majesty).” Maagarim: 18,278 attestations, root אלה 1.

Born in Genesis 1:1 — a plural noun governing singular verbs — landing three millennia later in a villager's blessing: ירחמהו אלקים.

השמים

Word study · first seen here

Klein: “visible heavens, sky; Heaven, abode of God.” Maagarim: 11,125 attestations.

Named on day two — שמים ויקרא אלקים לרקיע — ending as pure landscape: the deep blue summer skies of Shami's 1937 prose.

ארעא

Word study · Onkelos

CAL ʾrʿ, ʾrʿʾ: “ground; land; Earth.” Common Aramaic in every dialect.

Onkelos's steady word for הארץ — six senses, soil to residue; the plural switches gender by dialect.

Genesis 1:2 · ×2

וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ וְחֹשֶׁךְ עַל־פְּנֵי תְהוֹם וְרוּחַ אֱלֹקִים מְרַחֶפֶת עַל־פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם׃
וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ וְחֹשֶׁךְ עַל־פְּנֵי תְהוֹם וְרוּחַ אֱלֹקִים מְרַחֶפֶת עַל־פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם׃
וְאַרְעָא הֲוַת צְדְיָא וְרֵיקַנְיָא וַחֲשׁוֹכָא פְּרַשׂ עַל אַפֵּי תְהוֹמָא וְרוּחָא מִן קֳדָם יְיָ מְנַשְּׁבָא עַל אַפֵּי מַיָּא׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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ויאמר

Word study · first seen here

The dictionary's most frequent kal verb: 205,965 attestations.

Opens with ויאמר אלקים יהי אור; lands as אמר שיך דבור — "said Sheikh Dabur" — in 1937 dialogue.

Genesis 1:3 · ×2

וַיֹּ֥אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֖ים יְהִ֣י אֹ֑ור וַיְהִי־אֹֽור׃
וַיֹּ֥אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֖ים יְהִ֣י אֹ֑ור וַיְהִי־אֹֽור׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ יְהֵי נְהוֹרָא וַהֲוָה נְהוֹרָא׃

Genesis 1:4 · ×2

וַיַּ֣רְא אֱלֹקִ֔ים אֶת־הָאֹ֖ור כִּי־טֹ֑וב וַיַּבְדֵּ֣ל אֱלֹקִ֔ים בֵּ֥ין הָאֹ֖ור וּבֵ֥ין הַחֹֽשֶׁךְ׃
וַיַּ֣רְא אֱלֹקִ֔ים אֶת־הָאֹ֖ור כִּי־טֹ֑וב וַיַּבְדֵּ֣ל אֱלֹקִ֔ים בֵּ֥ין הָאֹ֖ור וּבֵ֥ין הַחֹֽשֶׁךְ׃
וַחֲזָא יְיָ יָת נְהוֹרָא אֲרֵי טָב וְאַפְרֵשׁ יְיָ בֵּין נְהוֹרָא וּבֵין חֲשׁוֹכָא׃

Genesis 1:5 · ×2

וַיִּקְרָ֨א אֱלֹקִ֜ים | לָאֹור֙ יֹ֔ום וְלַחֹ֖שֶׁךְ קָ֣רָא לָ֑יְלָה וַיְהִי־עֶ֥רֶב וַיְהִי־בֹ֖קֶר יֹ֥ום אֶחָֽד׃
וַיִּקְרָ֨א אֱלֹקִ֜ים | לָאֹור֙ יֹ֔ום וְלַחֹ֖שֶׁךְ קָ֣רָא לָ֑יְלָה וַיְהִי־עֶ֥רֶב וַיְהִי־בֹ֖קֶר יֹ֥ום אֶחָֽד׃
וּקְרָא יְיָ לִנְהוֹרָא יְמָמָא וְלַחֲשׁוֹכָא קְרָא לֵילְיָא וַהֲוָה רְמַשׁ וַהֲוָה צְפַר יוֹמָא חַד׃

Genesis 1:6 · ×2

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֔ים יְהִ֥י רָקִ֖יעַ בְּתֹ֣וךְ הַמָּ֑יִם וִיהִ֥י מַבְדִּ֖יל בֵּ֥ין מַ֥יִם לָמָֽיִם׃
וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֔ים יְהִ֥י רָקִ֖יעַ בְּתֹ֣וךְ הַמָּ֑יִם וִיהִ֥י מַבְדִּ֖יל בֵּ֥ין מַ֥יִם לָמָֽיִם׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ יְהֵי רְקִיעָא בְּמִצְיעוּת מַיָּא וִיהֵי מַפְרִישׁ בֵּין מַיָּא לְמַיָּא׃

Genesis 1:7 · ×2

וַיַּ֣עַשׂ אֱלֹקִ֗ים אֶת־הָרָקִ֑יעַ וַיַּבְדֵּ֗ל בֵּ֣ין הַמַּ֣יִם׀ אֲשֶׁ֣ר מִתַּ֣חַת לָרָקִ֗יעַ וּבֵ֣ין הַמַּ֣יִם אֲשֶׁ֣ר מֵעַ֣ל לָרָקִ֗יעַ וַיְהִי־כֵֽן׃
וַיַּ֣עַשׂ אֱלֹקִ֗ים אֶת־הָרָקִ֑יעַ וַיַּבְדֵּ֗ל בֵּ֣ין הַמַּ֣יִם׀ אֲשֶׁ֣ר מִתַּ֣חַת לָרָקִ֗יעַ וּבֵ֣ין הַמַּ֣יִם אֲשֶׁ֣ר מֵעַ֣ל לָרָקִ֗יעַ וַיְהִי־כֵֽן׃
וַעֲבַד יְיָ יָת רְקִיעָא וְאַפְרֵישׁ בֵּין מַיָּא דִּי מִלְּרַע לִרְקִיעָא וּבֵין מַיָּא דִּי מֵעַל לִרְקִיעָא וַהֲוָה כֵן׃

Genesis 1:8 · ×2

וַיִּקְרָ֨א אֱלֹקִ֜ים לָרָקִ֣יעַ שָׁמָ֗יִם וַיְהִי־עֶ֥רֶב וַיְהִי־בֹ֖קֶר יֹ֥ום שֵׁנִֽי׃
וַיִּקְרָ֨א אֱלֹקִ֜ים לָרָקִ֣יעַ שָׁמָ֗יִם וַיְהִי־עֶ֥רֶב וַיְהִי־בֹ֖קֶר יֹ֥ום שֵׁנִֽי׃
וּקְרָא יְיָ לִרְקִיעָא שְׁמַיָּא וַהֲוָה רְמַשׁ וַהֲוָה צְפַר יוֹם תִּנְיָן׃

Genesis 1:9 · ×2

וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֗ים יִקָּווּ֙ הַמַּ֣יִם מִתַּ֣חַת הַשָּׁמַ֔יִם אֶל־מָקֹ֥ום אֶחָ֖ד וְתֵרָאֶ֣ה הַיַּבָּשָׁ֑ה וַיְהִי־כֵֽן׃
וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אֱלֹקִ֗ים יִקָּווּ֙ הַמַּ֣יִם מִתַּ֣חַת הַשָּׁמַ֔יִם אֶל־מָקֹ֥ום אֶחָ֖ד וְתֵרָאֶ֣ה הַיַּבָּשָׁ֑ה וַיְהִי־כֵֽן׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ יִתְכַּנְשׁוּן מַיָּא מִתְּחוֹת שְׁמַיָּא לַאֲתַר חַד וְתִתְחֲזֵי יַבֶּשְׁתָּא וַהֲוָה כֵן׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 1:10 · ×2

וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹקִים | לַיַּבָּשָׁה אֶרֶץ וּלְמִקְוֵה הַמַּיִם קָרָא יַמִּים וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב:
וַיִּקְרָא אֱלֹקִים | לַיַּבָּשָׁה אֶרֶץ וּלְמִקְוֵה הַמַּיִם קָרָא יַמִּים וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב:
וּקְרָא יְיָ לְיַבֶּשְׁתָּא אַרְעָא וּלְבֵית כְּנִישׁוּת מַיָּא קְרָא יַמְמֵי וַחֲזָא יְיָ אֲרֵי טָב:

Genesis 1:11 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים תְּדַשֵּׁא הָאָרֶץ דֶּשֶׁא עֵשֶׂב מַזְרִיעַ זֶרַע עֵץ פְּרִי׀ עֹשֶׂה פְּרִי׀ לְמִינוֹ אֲשֶׁר זַרְעוֹ־בוֹ עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיְהִי־כֵן:
וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים תְּדַשֵּׁא הָאָרֶץ דֶּשֶׁא עֵשֶׂב מַזְרִיעַ זֶרַע עֵץ פְּרִי׀ עֹשֶׂה פְּרִי׀ לְמִינוֹ אֲשֶׁר זַרְעוֹ־בוֹ עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיְהִי־כֵן:
וַאֲמַר יְיָ תַּדְאֵית אַרְעָא דִּיתְאָה עִסְבָּא דְּבַר זַרְעֵהּ מְזַדְּרַע אִילַן פֵּירִין עָבֵד פֵּירִין לְזַנֵּהּ דִּי בַר זַרְעֵהּ בֵּהּ עַל אַרְעָא וַהֲוָה כֵן:

Genesis 1:12 · ×2

וַתּוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ דֶּשֶׁא עֵשֶׂב מַזְרִיעַ זֶרַע׀ לְמִינֵהוּ וְעֵץ עֹשֶׂה־פְּרִי אֲשֶׁר זַרְעוֹ־בוֹ לְמִינֵהוּ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב:
וַתּוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ דֶּשֶׁא עֵשֶׂב מַזְרִיעַ זֶרַע׀ לְמִינֵהוּ וְעֵץ עֹשֶׂה־פְּרִי אֲשֶׁר זַרְעוֹ־בוֹ לְמִינֵהוּ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב:
וְאַפֵּקַת אַרְעָא דִּיתְאָה עִסְבָּא דְּבַר זַרְעֵהּ מְזַדְּרַע לְזַנּוֹהִי וְאִילַן עָבֵד פֵּירִין דְּבַר זַרְעֵהּ בֵּהּ לְזַנּוֹהִי וַחֲזָא יְיָ אֲרֵי טָב:

Genesis 1:13 · ×2

וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר יוֹם שְׁלִישִׁי:
וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר יוֹם שְׁלִישִׁי:
וַהֲוָה רְמַשׁ וַהֲוָה צְפַר יוֹם תְּלִיתָאי:

Genesis 1:14 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים יְהִי מְאֹרֹת׀ בִּרְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמַיִם לְהַבְדִּיל בֵּין הַיּוֹם וּבֵין הַלָּיְלָה וְהָיוּ לְאֹתֹת׀ וּלְמוֹעֲדִים וּלְיָמִים וְשָׁנִים:
וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים יְהִי מְאֹרֹת׀ בִּרְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמַיִם לְהַבְדִּיל בֵּין הַיּוֹם וּבֵין הַלָּיְלָה וְהָיוּ לְאֹתֹת׀ וּלְמוֹעֲדִים וּלְיָמִים וְשָׁנִים:
וַאֲמַר יְיָ יְהוֹן נְהוֹרִין בִּרְקִיעָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא לְאַפְרָשָׁא בֵּין יְמָמָא וּבֵין לֵילְיָא וִיהוֹן לְאָתִין וּלְזִמְנִין וּלְמִימְנֵי בְּהוֹן יוֹמִין וּשְׁנִין:

Genesis 1:15 · ×2

וְהָיוּ לִמְאוֹרֹת׀ בִּרְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמַיִם לְהָאִיר עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיְהִי־כֵן:
וְהָיוּ לִמְאוֹרֹת׀ בִּרְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמַיִם לְהָאִיר עַל־הָאָרֶץ וַיְהִי־כֵן:
וִיהוֹן לִנְהוֹרִין בִּרְקִיעָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא לְאַנְהָרָא עַל אַרְעָא וַהֲוָה כֵן:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

Genesis 1:16 · ×2

וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־שְׁנֵי הַמְּאֹרֹת הַגְּדֹלִים אֶת־הַמָּאוֹר הַגָּדֹל לְמֶמְשֶׁלֶת הַיּוֹם וְאֶת־הַמָּאוֹר הַקָּטֹן לְמֶמְשֶׁלֶת הַלָּיְלָה וְאֵת הַכּוֹכָבִים׃

וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־שְׁנֵי הַמְּאֹרֹת הַגְּדֹלִים אֶת־הַמָּאוֹר הַגָּדֹל לְמֶמְשֶׁלֶת הַיּוֹם וְאֶת־הַמָּאוֹר הַקָּטֹן לְמֶמְשֶׁלֶת הַלָּיְלָה וְאֵת הַכּוֹכָבִים׃

וַעֲבַד יְיָ יָת תְּרֵין נְהוֹרַיָּא רַבְרְבַיָּא יָת נְהוֹרָא רַבָּא לְמִשְׁלַט בְּיוֹמָא וְיָת נְהוֹרָא זְעֵרָא לְמִשְׁלַט בְּלֵילְיָא וְיָת כּוֹכְבַיָּא׃

Genesis 1:17 · ×2

וַיִּתֵּן אֹתָם אֱלֹקִים בִּרְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמָיִם לְהָאִיר עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃

וַיִּתֵּן אֹתָם אֱלֹקִים בִּרְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמָיִם לְהָאִיר עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃

וִיהַב יָתְהוֹן יְיָ בִּרְקִיעָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא לְאַנְהָרָא עַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 1:18 · ×2

וְלִמְשֹׁל בַּיּוֹם וּבַלַּיְלָה וּלְהַבְדִּיל בֵּין הָאוֹר וּבֵין הַחֹשֶׁךְ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב׃

וְלִמְשֹׁל בַּיּוֹם וּבַלַּיְלָה וּלְהַבְדִּיל בֵּין הָאוֹר וּבֵין הַחֹשֶׁךְ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב׃

וּלְמִשְׁלַט בְּיוֹמָא וּבְלֵילְיָא וּלְאַפְרָשָׁא בֵּין נְהוֹרָא וּבֵין חֲשׁוֹכָא וַחֲזָא יְיָ אֲרֵי טָב׃

Genesis 1:19 · ×2

וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר יוֹם רְבִיעִי׃

וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר יוֹם רְבִיעִי׃

וַהֲוָה רְמַשׁ וַהֲוָה צְפַר יוֹם רְבִיעָאי׃

Genesis 1:20 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים יִשְׁרְצוּ הַמַּיִם שֶׁרֶץ נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה וְעוֹף יְעוֹפֵף עַל־הָאָרֶץ עַל־פְּנֵי רְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמָיִם׃

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים יִשְׁרְצוּ הַמַּיִם שֶׁרֶץ נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה וְעוֹף יְעוֹפֵף עַל־הָאָרֶץ עַל־פְּנֵי רְקִיעַ הַשָּׁמָיִם׃

וַאֲמַר יְיָ יִרְחֲשׁוּן מַיָּא רְחֵשׁ נַפְשָׁא חַיְתָא וְעוֹפָא יְפָרַח עַל אַרְעָא עַל אַפֵּי רְקִיעָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא׃

Genesis 1:21 · ×2

וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹקִים אֶת־הַתַּנִּינִם הַגְּדֹלִים וְאֵת כָּל־נֶפֶשׁ הַחַיָּה | הָרֹמֶשֶׂת אֲשֶׁר שָׁרְצוּ הַמַּיִם לְמִינֵהֶם וְאֵת כָּל־עוֹף כָּנָף לְמִינֵהוּ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב׃

וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹקִים אֶת־הַתַּנִּינִם הַגְּדֹלִים וְאֵת כָּל־נֶפֶשׁ הַחַיָּה | הָרֹמֶשֶׂת אֲשֶׁר שָׁרְצוּ הַמַּיִם לְמִינֵהֶם וְאֵת כָּל־עוֹף כָּנָף לְמִינֵהוּ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב׃

וּבְרָא יְיָ יָת תַּנִּינַיָּא רַבְרְבַיָּא וְיָת כָּל נַפְשָׁא חַיְתָא דִּרְחִשָׁא דִּי אַרְחִישׁוּ מַיָּא לְזִנֵיהוֹן וְיָת כָּל עוֹפָא דְּפָרַח לְזִנוֹהִי וַחֲזָא יְיָ אֲרֵי טָב׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

Genesis 1:22 · ×2

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם אֱלֹקִים לֵאמֹר פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּמִלְאוּ אֶת־הַמַּיִם בַּיַּמִּים וְהָעוֹף יִרֶב בָּאָרֶץ׃
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם אֱלֹקִים לֵאמֹר פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּמִלְאוּ אֶת־הַמַּיִם בַּיַּמִּים וְהָעוֹף יִרֶב בָּאָרֶץ׃
וּבָרִיךְ יָתְהוֹן יְיָ לְמֵימָר פּוּשׁוּ וּסְגוּ וּמְלוּ יָת מַיָּא בְּיַמְמַיָּא וְעוֹפָא יִסְגֵּי בְּאַרְעָא׃

Genesis 1:23 · ×2

וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר יוֹם חֲמִישִׁי׃
וַיְהִי־עֶרֶב וַיְהִי־בֹקֶר יוֹם חֲמִישִׁי׃
וַהֲוָה רְמַשׁ וַהֲוָה צְפַר יוֹם חֲמִישָׁאי׃

Genesis 1:24 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים תּוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה לְמִינָהּ בְּהֵמָה וָרֶמֶשׂ וְחַיְתוֹ־אֶרֶץ לְמִינָהּ וַיְהִי־כֵן׃
וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים תּוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה לְמִינָהּ בְּהֵמָה וָרֶמֶשׂ וְחַיְתוֹ־אֶרֶץ לְמִינָהּ וַיְהִי־כֵן׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ תַּפֵּק אַרְעָא נַפְשָׁא חַיְתָא לְזִנַהּ בְּעִיר וּרְחֵשׁ וְחַוַת אַרְעָא לְזִנַהּ וַהֲוָה כֵן׃

Genesis 1:25 · ×2

וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־חַיַּת הָאָרֶץ לְמִינָהּ וְאֶת־הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ וְאֵת כָּל־רֶמֶשׂ הָאֲדָמָה לְמִינֵהוּ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב׃
וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־חַיַּת הָאָרֶץ לְמִינָהּ וְאֶת־הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ וְאֵת כָּל־רֶמֶשׂ הָאֲדָמָה לְמִינֵהוּ וַיַּרְא אֱלֹקִים כִּי־טוֹב׃
וַעֲבַד יְיָ יָת חַוַת אַרְעָא לְזִנַהּ וְיָת בְּעִירָא לְזִנַהּ וְיָת כָּל רְחֵשָׁא דְאַרְעָא לְזִנוֹהִי וַחֲזָא יְיָ אֲרֵי טָב׃

Genesis 1:26 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים נַעֲשֶׂה אָדָם בְּצַלְמֵנוּ כִּדְמוּתֵנוּ וְיִרְדּוּ בִּדְגַת הַיָּם וּבְעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבְכָל־הָאָרֶץ וּבְכָל־הָרֶמֶשׂ הָרֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים נַעֲשֶׂה אָדָם בְּצַלְמֵנוּ כִּדְמוּתֵנוּ וְיִרְדּוּ בִּדְגַת הַיָּם וּבְעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבְכָל־הָאָרֶץ וּבְכָל־הָרֶמֶשׂ הָרֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַאֲמַר יְיָ נַעֲבִיד אֱינָשָׁא בְּצַלְמָנָא כִּדְמוּתָנָא וְיִשְׁלְטוּן בְּנוּנֵי יַמָּא וּבְעוֹפָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא וּבִבְעִירָא וּבְכָל אַרְעָא וּבְכָל רְחֵשָׁא דְּרָחֵשׁ עַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 1:27 · ×2

וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹקִים | אֶת־הָאָדָם בְּצַלְמוֹ בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹקִים בָּרָא אֹתוֹ זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בָּרָא אֹתָם׃
וַיִּבְרָא אֱלֹקִים | אֶת־הָאָדָם בְּצַלְמוֹ בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹקִים בָּרָא אֹתוֹ זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בָּרָא אֹתָם׃
וּבְרָא יְיָ יָת אָדָם בְּצַלְמֵהּ בְּצַלְמָא דַיְיָ בְּרָא יָתֵהּ דְּכַר וְנוּקְבָא בְּרָא יָתְהוֹן׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

Genesis 1:28 · ×2

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם֙ אֱלֹקִ֔ים וַיֹּ֥אמֶר לָהֶ֖ם אֱלֹקִ֑ים פְּר֣וּ וּרְב֗וּ וּמִלְא֛וּ אֶת־הָאָ֖רֶץ וְכִבְשֻׁ֑הָ וּרְד֗וּ בִּדְגַ֤ת הַיָּם֙ וּבְעֹ֣וף הַשָּׁמַ֔יִם וּבְכָל־חַיָּ֖ה הָרֹמֶ֥שֶׂת עַל־הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם֙ אֱלֹקִ֔ים וַיֹּ֥אמֶר לָהֶ֖ם אֱלֹקִ֑ים פְּר֣וּ וּרְב֗וּ וּמִלְא֛וּ אֶת־הָאָ֖רֶץ וְכִבְשֻׁ֑הָ וּרְד֗וּ בִּדְגַ֤ת הַיָּם֙ וּבְעֹ֣וף הַשָּׁמַ֔יִם וּבְכָל־חַיָּ֖ה הָרֹמֶ֥שֶׂת עַל־הָאָֽרֶץ׃
וּבְרִיךְ יְתְהוֹן יְיָ֔ וַאֲמַ֥ר לְהוֹן֙ יְיָ֔ פּוּשׁוּ֙ וְסִגּוּ֙ וּמְל֣וּ יָ֔ת אַרְעָ֖א וּתְקוֹפוּ֑הִי עֲלַ֗הּ וּשְׁלוּטוּ֙ בְּנוּנֵ֣י יַמָּ֔א וּבְעוֹפָ֖א דִּשְׁמַיָּ֑א וּבְכָל חַיְתָ֕א דְּרָחֶ֥שָׁא עַל אַרְעָֽא׃

Genesis 1:29 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר֮ אֱלֹקִים֒ הִנֵּ֣ה נָתַ֤תִּי לָכֶם֙ אֶת־כָּל־עֵ֣שֶׂב | זֹרֵ֣עַ זֶ֔רַע אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־פְּנֵ֣י כָל־הָאָ֑רֶץ וְאֶת־כָּל־הָעֵ֗ץ אֲשֶׁר־בּ֤וֹ פְרִי־עֵץ֙ זֹרֵ֣עַ זָ֔רַע לָכֶ֖ם יִהְיֶ֥ה לְאָכְלָֽה׃
וַיֹּאמֶר֮ אֱלֹקִים֒ הִנֵּ֣ה נָתַ֤תִּי לָכֶם֙ אֶת־כָּל־עֵ֣שֶׂב | זֹרֵ֣עַ זֶ֔רַע אֲשֶׁ֖ר עַל־פְּנֵ֣י כָל־הָאָ֑רֶץ וְאֶת־כָּל־הָעֵ֗ץ אֲשֶׁר־בּ֤וֹ פְרִי־עֵץ֙ זֹרֵ֣עַ זָ֔רַע לָכֶ֖ם יִהְיֶ֥ה לְאָכְלָֽה׃
וַאֲמַ֣ר יְיָ֔ הָא֥ יְהָבִ֖ית לְכוֹן֙ יָ֣ת כָּל עִסְבָּ֣א דְּבַ֣ר זַרְעָ֔ה מְזַדְּרַ֖ע דִּ֣י עַל אַפֵּ֣י כָ֔ל אַרְעָ֑א וְיָ֗ת כָּל אִילָנָא֙ דִּ֣י בֵ֣הּ פֵּירֵ֣י אִילָנָ֔א דְּבַ֣ר זַרְעָ֔ה מְזַדְּרַ֖ע לְכוֹן֙ יְהֵ֣א לְמֵיכָֽל׃

Genesis 1:30 · ×2

וּלְכָל־חַיַּ֣ת הָאָ֗רֶץ וּלְכָל־עוֹף֙ הַשָּׁמַ֔יִם וּלְכֹ֖ל | רוֹמֵ֣שׂ עַל־הָאָ֑רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־בּ֤וֹ נֶ֙פֶשׁ֙ חַיָּ֔ה אֶת־כָּל־יֶ֥רֶק עֵ֖שֶׂב לְאָכְלָ֑ה וַיְהִי־כֵֽן׃
וּלְכָל־חַיַּ֣ת הָאָ֗רֶץ וּלְכָל־עוֹף֙ הַשָּׁמַ֔יִם וּלְכֹ֖ל | רוֹמֵ֣שׂ עַל־הָאָ֑רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־בּ֤וֹ נֶ֙פֶשׁ֙ חַיָּ֔ה אֶת־כָּל־יֶ֥רֶק עֵ֖שֶׂב לְאָכְלָ֑ה וַיְהִי־כֵֽן׃
וּלְכָל חֵיוַת אַרְעָא֙ וּלְכָל֙ עוֹפָ֣א דִּשְׁמַיָּ֔א וּלְכֹ֖ל דְּרָחֵ֣שׁ עַל אַרְעָ֑א דִּ֣י בֵ֣הּ נַפְשָׁ֔א חַיְתָ֕א יָ֚ת כָּל יְרוֹק֙ עִסְבָּ֣א לְמֵיכָ֔ל וַהֲוָ֖ה כֵֽן׃

Genesis 1:31 · ×2

וַיַּ֣רְא אֱלֹקִים֮ אֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר֒ עָשָׂ֣ה וְהִנֵּה־טֹ֣וב מְאֹ֔ד וַיְהִי־עֶ֥רֶב וַיְהִי־בֹ֖קֶר יֹ֥ום הַשִּׁשִּֽׁי׃
וַיַּ֣רְא אֱלֹקִים֮ אֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר֒ עָשָׂ֣ה וְהִנֵּה־טֹ֣וב מְאֹ֔ד וַיְהִי־עֶ֥רֶב וַיְהִי־בֹ֖קֶר יֹ֥ום הַשִּׁשִּֽׁי׃
וַחֲזָא יְיָ֔ יָ֚ת כָּל דִּ֣י עֲבַ֔ד וְהָא֙ תַּקִּ֣ין לַחֲדָ֔א וַהֲוָ֥ה רְמַ֖שׁ וַהֲוָ֣ה צְפַ֑ר יוֹם֙ שְׁתִיתָאֵ֔י׃

Genesis 2:1 · ×2

וַיְכֻלּ֛וּ הַשָּׁמַ֥יִם וְהָאָ֖רֶץ וְכָל־צְבָאָֽם׃
וַיְכֻלּ֛וּ הַשָּׁמַ֥יִם וְהָאָ֖רֶץ וְכָל־צְבָאָֽם׃
וְאִשְׁתַּכְלִ֖ילוּ שְׁמַיָּ֣א וְאַרְעָ֑א וְכָל֖ חֵילֵיהוֹן׃

Genesis 2:2 · ×2

וַיְכַ֤ל אֱלֹקִים֙ בַּיֹּ֣ום הַשְּׁבִיעִ֔י מְלַאכְתֹּ֖ו אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֑ה וַיִּשְׁבֹּת֙ בַּיֹּ֣ום הַשְּׁבִיעִ֔י מִכָּל־מְלַאכְתֹּ֖ו אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָֽׂה׃
וַיְכַ֤ל אֱלֹקִים֙ בַּיֹּ֣ום הַשְּׁבִיעִ֔י מְלַאכְתֹּ֖ו אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֑ה וַיִּשְׁבֹּת֙ בַּיֹּ֣ום הַשְּׁבִיעִ֔י מִכָּל־מְלַאכְתֹּ֖ו אֲשֶׁ֥ר עָשָֽׂה׃
וְשֵׁיצֵ֣י יְיָ֔ בְּיוֹמָ֖א שְׁבִיעָ֑אָה עֲבַדְתֵּ֣ה דִּ֔י עֲבַ֖ד וְנַ֣ח בְּיוֹמָ֔א שְׁבִיעָ֖אָה מִכֹּ֣ל עֲבַדְתֵּ֑ה דִּ֖י עֲבָֽד׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

Genesis 2:3 · ×2

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אֹתוֹ כִּי בוֹ שָׁבַת מִכָּל־מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר־בָּרָא אֱלֹקִים לַעֲשׂוֹת׃
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אֹתוֹ כִּי בוֹ שָׁבַת מִכָּל־מְלַאכְתּוֹ אֲשֶׁר־בָּרָא אֱלֹקִים לַעֲשׂוֹת׃
וּבָרִיךְ יְיָ יָת יוֹמָא שְׁבִיעָאָה וְקַדִּישׁ יָתֵהּ אֲרֵי בֵּהּ נַח מִכָּל עֲבִדְתֵּהּ דִּי בְרָא יְיָ לְמֶעְבַּד׃

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

All 58 of Rashi's comments on Genesis 1:1-2:3, in his Hebrew with an English rendering — the dibur hamatchil in bold, the rest following.

בראשית.

אָמַר רַבִּי יִצְחָק לֹא הָיָה צָרִיךְ לְהַתְחִיל אֶת הַתּוֹרָה אֶלָּא מֵהַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם,

בראשית *IN THE BEGINNING — Rabbi Isaac said:*

שֶׁהִיא מִצְוָה רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁנִּצְטַוּוּ בָּהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל, וּמַה טַּעַם פָּתַח בִּבְרֵאשִׁית?

The Torah which is the Law book of Israel should have commenced with the verse (Exodus 12:2) "This month shall be unto you the first of the months" which is the first commandment given to Israel.

מִשּׁוּם כֹּחַ מַעֲשָׂיו הִגִּיד לְעַמּוֹ לָתֵת לָהֶם נַחֲלַת גּוֹיִם (תהילים קי"א),

What is the reason, then, that it commences with the account of the Creation?

שֶׁאִם יֹאמְרוּ אֻמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם לְיִשְׂרָאֵל לִסְטִים אַתֶּם, שֶׁכְּבַשְׁתֶּם אַרְצוֹת שִׁבְעָה גּוֹיִם,

Because of the thought expressed in the text (Psalms 111:6) "He declared to His people the strength of His works (i.e.

הֵם אוֹמְרִים לָהֶם כָּל הָאָרֶץ שֶׁל הַקָּבָ"ה הִיא,

He gave an account of the work of Creation), in order that He might give them the heritage of the nations." For should the peoples of the world say to Israel, "You are robbers, because you took by force the lands of the seven nations of Canaan", Israel may reply to them, "All the earth belongs to the Holy One, blessed be He;

הוּא בְרָאָהּ וּנְתָנָהּ לַאֲשֶׁר יָשַׁר בְּעֵינָיו, בִּרְצוֹנוֹ נְתָנָהּ לָהֶם,

He created it and gave it to whom He pleased.

וּבִרְצוֹנוֹ נְטָלָהּ מֵהֶם וּנְתָנָהּ לָנוּ׃

When He willed He gave it to them, and when He willed He took it from them and gave it to us" (Yalkut Shimoni on Torah 187).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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בראשית ברא אֵין הַמִּקְרָא הַזֶּה אוֹמֵר

אֶלָּא דָּרְשֵׁנִי, כְּמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּהוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ בִּשְׁבִיל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת רֵאשִׁית דַּרְכּוֹ (משלי ח'),

וּבִשְׁבִיל יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ רֵאשִׁית תְּבוּאָתוֹ (ירמיה ב'); וְאִם בָּאתָ לִפְרָשׁוֹ כִּפְשׁוּטוֹ,

בראשית ברא IN THE BEGINNING GOD CREATED — This verse calls aloud for explanation in the manner that our Rabbis explained it:

כָּךְ פֵּרְשֵׁהוּ בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּרִיאַת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ,

God created the world for the sake of the Torah which is called (Proverbs 8:22) "The beginning (ראשית) of His (God's) way", and for the sake of Israel who are called (Jeremiah 2:3) "The beginning (ראשית) of His (God's) increase".

וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ וְחֹשֶׁךְ וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹקִים יְהִי אוֹר וְלֹא בָא הַמִּקְרָא לְהוֹרוֹת סֵדֶר הַבְּרִיאָה לוֹמַר שֶׁאֵלּוּ קַדְמוּ, שֶׁאִם בָּא לְהוֹרוֹת כָּךְ,

If, however, you wish to explain it in its plain sense, explain it thus:

הָיָה לוֹ לִכְתֹּב בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה בָּרָא אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְגוֹ' שֶׁאֵין לְךָ רֵאשִׁית בַּמִּקְרָא שֶׁאֵינוֹ דָבוּק לַתֵּבָה שֶׁלְּאַחֲרָיו,

At the beginning of the Creation of heaven and earth when the earth was without form and void and there was darkness, God said, "Let there be light".

כְּמוֹ בְּרֵאשִׁית מַמְלֶכֶת יְהוֹיָקִים (שם כ"ז), רֵאשִׁית מַמְלַכְתּוֹ (בראשית י'), רֵאשִׁית דְּגָנְךָ (דברים י"ח, ד'),

The text does not intend to point out the order of the acts of Creation — to state that these (heaven and earth) were created first;

אַף כָּאן אַתָּה אוֹמֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹקִים וְגוֹ', כְּמוֹ בְּרֵאשִׁית בְּרֹא;

for if it intended to point this out, it should have written בראשונה ברא את השמים וגו' *"At first God created etc." And for this reason:*

וְדוֹמֶה לוֹ תְּחִלַּת דִּבֶּר ה' בְּהוֹשֵׁעַ (הושע א'),

Because, wherever the word ראשית *occurs in Scripture, it is in the construct state.*

כְּלוֹמַר תְּחִלַּת דִּבּוּרוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּבָ"ה בְּהוֹשֵׁעַ, וַיֹּאמֶר ה' אֶל הוֹשֵׁעַ וְגוֹ'.

E. g., (Jeremiah 26:1) "In the beginning of (בראשית) the reign of Jehoiakim";

וְאִ"תּ לְהוֹרוֹת בָּא שֶׁאֵלּוּ תְּחִלָּה נִבְרְאוּ, וּפֵרוּשׁוֹ בְּרֵאשִׁית הַכֹּל בָּרָא אֵלּוּ

וְיֵשׁ לְךָ מִקְרָאוֹת שֶׁמְּקַצָּרִים לְשׁוֹנָם וּמְמַעֲטִים תֵּבָה אַחַת,

(Genesis 10:10) "The beginning of (ראשית) his kingdom";

כְּמוֹ כִּי לֹא סָגַר דַּלְתֵי בִטְנִי (איוב ג'),

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(Deuteronomy 18:4) "The first fruit of (ראשית) thy corn." Similarly here you must translate ברא אלקים בראשית *as though it read* בראשית ברוא, *at the beginning of God's creating.*

וְלֹא פֵּרֵשׁ מִי הַסּוֹגֵר וּכְמוֹ יִשָּׂא אֶת חֵיל דַּמֶּשֶׂק (ישעיהו ח'), וְלֹא פֵּרֵשׁ מִי יִשָּׂאֵנּוּ;

A similar grammatical construction (of a noun in construct followed by a verb) is:

וּכְמוֹ אִם יַחֲרוֹשׁ בַּבְּקָרִים (עמוס ו'),

(Hosea 1:2) בהושע תחלת דבר ה', *which is as much as to say, "At the beginning of God's speaking through Hosea, the Lord said to Hosea." Should you, however, insist that it does actually intend to point out that these (heaven and earth) were created first, and that the meaning is, "At the beginning of everything He created these, admitting therefore that the word* בראשית *is in the construct state and explaining the omission of a word signifying "everything" by saying that you have texts which are elliptical, omitting a word, as for example (Job 3:10) "Because it shut not up the doors of my mother's womb" where it does not explicitly explain who it was that closed the womb;*

וְלֹא פֵּרֵשׁ אִם יַחֲרוֹשׁ אָדָם בַּבְּקָרִים,

and (Isaiah 8:4) "He shall take away the spoil of Samaria" without explaining who shall take it away;

וּכְמוֹ מַגִּיד מֵרֵאשִׁית אַחֲרִית (ישעיהו מ"ו),

and (Amos 6:12) "Doth he plough with oxen," and it does not explicitly state, "Doth a man plough with oxen";

וְלֹא פֵּרֵשׁ מַגִּיד מֵרֵאשִׁית דָּבָר אַחֲרִית דָּבָר אִ"כְּ, תְּמַהּ עַל עַצְמְךָ, שֶׁהֲרֵי הַמַּיִם קָדְמוּ,

(Isaiah 46:10) "Declaring from the beginning the end," and it does not explicitly state, "Declaring from the beginning of a thing the end of a thing' — if it is so (that you assert that this verse intends to point out that heaven and earth were created first), you should be astonished at yourself, because as a matter of fact the waters were created before heaven and earth, for, lo, it is written, (v. 2) "The Spirit of God was hovering on the face of the waters," and Scripture had not yet disclosed when the creation of the waters took place — consequently you must learn from this that the creation of the waters preceded that of the earth.

שֶׁהֲרֵי כְּתִיב וְרוּחַ אֱלֹקִים מְרַחֶפֶת עַל פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם, וְעַדַיִין לֹא גִּלָּה הַמִּקְרָא, בְּרִיאַת הַמַּיִם מָתַי הָיְתָה, הָא לְמַדְתָּ, שֶׁקְּדְמוּ הַמַּיִם לָאָרֶץ, וְעוֹד, שֶׁהַשָּׁמַיִם מֵאֵשׁ וּמַיִם נִבְרְאוּ,

And a further proof that the heavens and earth were not the first thing created is that the heavens were created from fire (אש) and water (מים), from which it follows that fire and water were in existence before the heavens.

עַל כָּרְחָךְ לֹא לִמֵּד הַמִּקְרָא סֵדֶר הַמְּקְדָמִים וְהַמְּאֻחָרִים כְּלוּם:

Therefore you must admit that the text teaches nothing about the earlier or later sequence of the acts of Creation.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

ברא אלקים ולא נֶאֱמַר בָּרָא ה',
שֶׁבַּתְּחִלָּה עָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לִבְרֹאתוֹ בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין, רָאָה שֶׁאֵין הָעוֹלָם מִתְקַיֵּם,

הִקְדִּים מִדַּת רַחֲמִים וְשִׁתְּפָהּ לְמַה"דִּ,

ברא אלקים *GOD [AS JUDGE] CREATED — It does not state* ברא ה' *"The Lord (the Merciful One) created, because at first God intended to create it (the world) to be placed under the attribute (rule) of strict justice, but He realised that the world could not thus endure and therefore gave precedence to Divine Mercy allying it with Divine Justice.*

וְהַיְינוּ דִּכְתִיב בְּיוֹם עֲשׂוֹת ה' אֱלֹקִים אֶרֶץ וְשָׁמַיִם:

It is to this that what is written in (Genesis 2:4) alludes — "In the day that the Lord God made earth and heaven".

תהו ובהו.
תֹּהוּ לְשׁוֹן תֵּמַהּ וְשׁמָמוֹן, שֶׁאָדָם תּוֹהֶא וּמִשְׁתּוֹמֵם עַל בֹּהוּ שֶׁבָּהּ:

תהו ובהו *DESOLATE AND VOID — The word* תהו *signifies astonishment and amazement, for a person would have been astonished and amazed at its emptiness.*

תהו.
אשטורדי"שון בְּלַעַ"ז:

תהו *is estordison in old French.*

בהו.
לְשׁוֹן רֵקוּת וְצָדוּ:

בהו *VOID — The word signifies emptiness and empty space.*

על פני תהום.
עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם שֶׁעַל הָאָרֶץ:

על פני תהום *ON THE FACE OF THE DEEP — i. e. the waters which were upon the earth.*

ורוח אלקים מרחפת.
כִּסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד עוֹמֵד בָּאֲוִיר וּמְרַחֵף עַל פְּנֵי הַמַּיִם בְּרוּחַ פִּיו שֶׁל הַקָּבָ"ה וּבְמַאֲמָרוֹ, כְּיוֹנָה הַמְרַחֶפֶת עַל הַקֵּן, אקוב"טיר בְּלַעַ"ז:

ורוח אלקים מרחפת *AND THE SPIRIT OF GOD WAS HOVERING — The throne of Divine Glory was standing in space, hovering over the face of the waters by the breath of the mouth of the Holy One, blessed be He, and by His command, even as a dove hovers over its nest.*

In old French acoveter.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

וירא אלקים את האור כי טוב ויבדל.

אַף בָּזֶה אָנוּ צְרִיכִין לְדִבְרֵי אַגָּדָה,

וירא אלקים את האור כי טוב ויבדל *AND GOD SAW THE LIGHT THAT IT WAS GOOD, AND GOD CAUSED A DIVISION — Here, also, we must depend upon the statement of the Agada:*

He saw that the wicked were unworthy of using it (the light);

רָאָה שֶׁאֵינוֹ כְּדַאי לְהִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ בּוֹ רְשָׁעִים, וְהִבְדִּילוֹ לַצַּדִּיקִים לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא. וּלְפִי פְּשׁוּטוֹ כָּךְ פֵּרְשֻׁהוּ, רָאָה כִּי טוֹב,

He, therefore, set it apart (ויבדל), reserving it for the righteous in the world to come (Chagigah 12a).

But according to the plain sense explain it thus:

וְאֵין נָאֶה לוֹ וְלַחֹשֶׁךְ שֶׁיִּהְיוּ מִשְׁתַּמְּשִׁים בְּעֵרְבּוּבְיָא, וְקָבַע לָזֶה תְּחוּמוֹ בַּיּוֹם, וְלָזֶה תְּחוּמוֹ בַּלַּיְלָה:

He saw that it was good, and that it was not seemly that light and darkness should function together in a confused manner.

He therefore limited this one's sphere of activity to the daytime, and this one's sphere of activity to the nighttime (see Genesis Rabbah 3:6).

יום אחד.

לְפִי סֵדֶר לְשׁוֹן הַפָּרָשָׁה הָיָה לוֹ לִכְתֹּב יוֹם רִאשׁוֹן,

יום אחד *THE FIRST DAY (literally, one day) — According to the regular mode of expression used in this chapter it should be written here "first day", just as it is written with regard to the other days "the second", "the third", "the fourth".*

כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּשְׁאָר הַיָּמִים שֵׁנִי, שְׁלִישִׁי, רְבִיעִי, לָמָּה כָּתַב אֶחָד?

Why, then, does it write אחד *"one"?*

לְפִי שֶׁהָיָה הַקָּבָ"ה יָחִיד בְּעוֹלָמוֹ,

Because the Holy One, blessed be He, was then the Only One (Sole Being) in His Universe, since the angels were not created until the second day.

שֶׁלֹּא נִבְרְאוּ הַמַּלְאָכִים עַד יוֹם שֵׁנִי, כָּךְ מְפֹרָשׁ בִּבְ"רַ:

Thus it is explained in Genesis Rabbah (Genesis Rabbah 3:8).

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DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

יהי רקיע.

יֶחֱזַק הָרָקִיעַ, שֶׁאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁנִּבְרְאוּ שָׁמַיִם בְּיוֹם א' עֲדַיִן לַחִים הָיוּ וְקָרְשׁוּ בַּשֵּׁנִי מִגַּעֲרַת הַקָּבָ"ה בְּאָמְרוֹ יְהִי רָקִיעַ,

יהי רקיע *BE THERE AN EXPANSE — Let the expansion become fixed;*

וְזֶהוּ שֶׁכָּתַב (איוב כ"ו) עַמּוּדֵי שָׁמַיִם יְרוֹפָפוּ כָּל יוֹם רִאשׁוֹן, וּבַשֵּׁנִי יִתְמְהוּ מִגַּעֲרָתוֹ,

for although the heavens were created on the first day, they were still in a fluid form, and they became solidified only on the second day at the dread command (literally, rebuke) of the Holy One, blessed be He, when he said "Let the firmament be stable" (Genesis Rabbah 4:2).

כְּאָדָם שֶׁמִּשְׁתּוֹמֵם וְעוֹמֵד מִגַּעֲרַת הַמְאַיֵּם עָלָיו:

It is to this that allusion is made in what is written in (Job 26:11): "The pillars of heaven were trembling" (i. e. they were unstable) — this was during the whole of the first day — and on the second (Job 26:11): "they were astonished at His rebuke", like a man who stands immovable, amazed at the rebuke of one who terrifies him.

בתוך המים.

בְּאֶמְצַע הַמַּיִם, שֶׁיֵּשׁ הֶפְרֵשׁ בֵּין מַיִם הָעֶלְיוֹנִים לָרָקִיעַ כְּמוֹ בֵּין הָרָקִיעַ לַמַּיִם שֶׁעַל הָאָרֶץ, הָא לְמַדְתָּ, שֶׁהֵם תְּלוּיִים בְּמַאֲמָרוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ:

בתוך המים *IN THE MIDST OF THE WATERS — In the exact centre of the waters;*

because there is the same distance between the upper waters and the firmament as there is between the firmament and the waters that are upon the earth.

Thus you may infer that they (the upper waters) are suspended in space by the command of the King (Genesis Rabbah 4:3).

ויעש אלקים את הרקיע.

תִּקְּנוֹ עַל עָמְדוֹ, וְהֵיא עֲשִׂיָתוֹ, כְּמוֹ וְעָשְׂתָה אֶת צִפָּרְנֶיהָ (דברים כ"א):

ויעש אלקים את הרקיע *AND GOD MADE THE EXPANSE — He put it in proper condition in its place:*

this is the meaning of "making" it.

Similarly (Deuteronomy 21:12) ועשתה את צפרניה *"And she shall let grow (literally, make) her nails".*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

מעל לרקיע.

עַל הָרָקִיעַ לֹא נֶאֱמַר אֶלָּא מֵעַל לָרָקִיעַ, לְפִי שֶׁהֵן תְּלוּיִין בָּאֲוִיר.

וּמִפְּנֵי מָה לֹא נֶאֱמַר כִּי טוֹב בְּיוֹם שֵׁנִי?

מעל לרקיע *ABOVE THE EXPANSE — It is not said here* על הרקיע *"upon the firmament", but* מעל *"hanging from above", because they (the waters) were suspended in space (Genesis Rabbah 4:3).*

לְפִי שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה נִגְמָר מְלֶאכֶת הַמַּיִם עַד יוֹם שְׁלִישִׁי, וְהֵרֵי הִתְחִיל בָּהּ בְּשֵׁנִי,

Why is it not stated in reference to the work of the second day "that it was good"?

וְדָבָר שֶׁלֹּא נִגְמַר אֵינוֹ בְּמִלּוֹאוֹ וְטוּבוֹ;

וּבַשְּׁלִישִׁי שֶׁנִּגְמַר מְלֶאכֶת הַמַּיִם וְהִתְחִיל וְגָמַר מְלֶאכָה אַחֶרֶת, כְּפַל בּוֹ כִּי טוֹב שְׁתֵּי פְּעָמִים,

Because the work associated with water was not completed until the third day — He only began it on the second — and anything that is not completed is not in a state of perfection and at its best (and so cannot be termed "good").

אַחַת לְגָמַר מְלֶאכֶת הַשֵּׁנִי וְאַחַת לְגָמַר מְלֶאכֶת הַיּוֹם:

Therefore on the third day when He completed the work associated with water and another work was commenced and finished, the words כי טוב *are repeated, once in reference to the completion of the work of the second day, and again in reference to the completion of the work of that day (Genesis Rabbah 4:10).*

ויקרא אלקים לרקיע שמים.

שָׂא מַיִם, שָׁם מַיִם, אֵשׁ וּמַיִם, שֶׁעֵרְבָן זֶה בָּזֶה וְעָשָׂה מֵהֶם שָׁמַיִם:

ויקרא אלקים לרקיע שמים *AND GOD CALLED THE EXPANSE HEAVEN — The word "שמים", Heaven, may be regarded as made up of* שא מים *"Carry water", or* שם מים *"There is water", or* אש ומים *"Fire and water".*

He mingled fire with water and of them He made the heavens (Chagigah 12a).

יקוו המים.

שֶׁהָיוּ שְׁטוּחִין עַל פְּנֵי כָל הָאָרֶץ וְהִקְוָם בָּאוֹקְיָנוֹס הוּא הַיָּם הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבְּכָל הַיַּמִּים:

יקוו המים *THE WATERS SHALL BE DRAWN TOGETHER — For they were then spread over the surface of the whole earth, and He now gathered them together into what now constitutes the Ocean, which is the largest of all seas (Genesis Rabbah 5:2).*

קרא ימים.

וַהֲלֹא יָם אֶחָד הוּא? אֶלָּא אֵינוֹ דוֹמֶה טַעַם דְּג הָעוֹלֶה מִן הַיָּם בְּעַכּוֹ לְטַעַם דְּג הָעוֹלֶה מִן הַיָּם בְּאַסְפַּמְיָא:

קרא ימים *CALLED HE SEAS — But does it not form one great sea?*

But it speaks of seas because the taste of fish which comes up from the sea at Acco is not the same as the taste of fish which comes up from the sea at Aspamia (Genesis Rabbah 5:8).

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What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

תדשא הארץ דשא עשב.

לֹא דֶּשֶׁא לְשׁוֹן עֵשֶׂב וְלֹא עֵשֶׂב לְשׁוֹן דֶּשֶׁא,

וְלֹא הָיָה לְשׁוֹן הַמִּקְרָא לוֹמַר תַּעֲשֵׂיב הָאָרֶץ, שֶׁמִּינֵי דְשָׁאִים מְחֻלָּקִין,

כָּל אֶחָד לְעַצְמוֹ נִקְרָא עֵשֶׂב פְּלוֹנִי,

וְאֵין לְשׁוֹן לַמְדַבֵּר לוֹמַר דֶּשֶׁא פְּלוֹנִי,

שֶׁלְּשׁוֹן דֶּשֶׁא הוּא לְבִישַׁת הָאָרֶץ כְּשֶׁהִיא מִתְמַלֵּאת בְּדְשָׁאִים:

תדשא הארץ דשא עשב THE EARTH SHALL SPROUT FORTH SPROUTS, HERB — דשא does not mean the same as עשב nor does עשב mean the same as דשא so that it is not a correct expression in Biblical Hebrew to say תעשיב הארץ, for the species of דשא are all different, each by itself being called this or that עשב, and it would not be linguistically correct for a speaker to say this or that דשא, for by דשא is meant that which forms the covering of the ground when it is filled with herbage.

תדשא הארץ.

תִּתְמַלֵּא וְתִתְכַּסֶּה לְבוּשׁ עֲשָׂבִים. בִּלְשׁוֹן לַעַז נִקְרָא דֶּשֶׁא ארבריץ, כֻּלָּן בְּעִרְבּוּבְיָא, וְכָל שֹׁרֶשׁ לְעַצְמוֹ נִקְרָא עֵשֶׂב:

תדשא הארץ THE EARTH SHALL SPROUT FORTH [SPROUTS] — Let it be filled and covered with a garment of different grasses.

In old French דשא is called herbaries;

English herbage, meaning all species of herbs growing together collectively whilst each root by itself is called an עשב.

מזריע זרע.

שֶׁיְּגַדֵּל בּוֹ זַרְעוֹ לִזְרֹעַ מִמֶּנּוּ בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר:

מזריע זרע YIELDING SEED — that its seed should grow within itself, so that some of it may be sown in another spot.

עץ פרי.

שֶׁיְּהֵא טַעַם הָעֵץ כְּטַעַם הַפְּרִי, וְהִיא לֹא עָשְׂתָה כֵן,

עץ פרי FRUIT TREE — that the taste of the tree be exactly the same as that of the fruit.

אֶלָּא וַתּוֹצֵא הָאָרֶץ עֵץ עוֹשֶׂה פְּרִי וְלֹא הָעֵץ פְּרִי,

It did not, however, do this, but (v. 12) "the earth brought forth a tree yielding fruit" and the tree itself was not a fruit;

לְפִיכָךְ כְּשֶׁנִּתְקַלֵּל אָדָם עַל עֲוֹנוֹ נִפְקְדָה גַּם הִיא עַל עֲוֹנָהּ וְנִתְקַלְלָה:

therefore when Adam was cursed on account of his sin, it (the earth) was also visited (because of its sin) and was cursed also (Genesis Rabbah 5:9).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

אשר זרעו בו.

הֵן גַּרְעִינֵי כָל פְּרִי שֶׁמֵּהֶן הָאִילָן צוֹמֵחַ כְּשֶׁנּוֹטְעִין אוֹתוֹ:

אשר זרעו בו *WHOSE SEED IS IN ITSELF — This refers to the kernels of each kind of fruit from which the tree grows when they are planted.*

ותוצא הארץ וגו'.

אַע"פִּ שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר לְמִינֵהוּ בַּדְּשָׁאִין בְּצִוּוּיֵיהֶן,

שָׁמְעוּ שֶׁנִּצְטַוּוּ הָאִילָנוֹת עַל כָּךְ, נָשְׂאוּ קַ"וָ בְּעַצְמָן,

כַּמְּפֹרָשׁ בָּאַגָּדָה בְּשֶׁחִיטַת חֻלִּין:

ותוצא הארץ וגו *AND THE EARTH BROUGHT FORTH etc. — Although the expression* למינהו *according to its kind, was not used when the various kinds of herbage were bidden to come forth, they heard that the trees were so commanded and they applied to themselves the argument à fortiore (*ק"ו*), as it is explained in an Aggadic passage in (Chullin 60a).*

יהי מארת וגו'.

מִיּוֹם רִאשׁוֹן נִבְרְאוּ וּבֻרְבִּיעִי צִוָּה עֲלֵיהֶם לְהִתְּלוֹת בָּרָקִיעַ,

יהי מארת *BE THERE LUMINARIES — They had been created on the first day, but on the fourth He commanded them to be suspended in the firmament (Chagigah 12a).*

וְכֵן כָּל תּוֹלְדוֹת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ נִבְרְאוּ מִיּוֹם רִאשׁוֹן,

Indeed, all the productions of heaven and earth were created on the first day, but each of them was put in its place on that day when it was so commanded.

וְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד נִקְבַּע בַּיּוֹם שֶׁנִּגְזַר עָלָיו, הוּא שֶׁכָּתוּב אֵת הַשָּׁמַיִם, לְרַבּוֹת תּוֹלְדוֹתֵיהֶם, וְאֵת הָאָרֶץ, לְרַבּוֹת תּוֹלְדוֹתֶיהָ:

In reference to this it is written את השמים *(v. 1) In the beginning God created that which was* את *with the heavens etc., in order to include all the productions of heaven,* ואת הארץ *to include all its (the earth's) productions (Genesis Rabbah 12:4).*

יהי מארת.

חָסֵר וְי"ו כְּתִיב, עַל שֶׁהוּא יוֹם מְאֵרָה לִפֹּל אַסְכָּרָה בַּתִּינוֹקוֹת,

יהי מארת *The word is written without the* ו *after the* א *(so that it may be read* מארת, *cursed), because it is a cursed day when children are liable to suffer from croup.*

הוּא שֶׁשָּׁנִינוּ בְּד' הָיוּ מִתְעַנִּים עַל אַסְכָּרָה שֶׁלֹּא תִּפֹּל בַּתִּינוֹקוֹת:

In reference to this we read (in Taanit 27b):

On the fourth day of the week they used to fast to avert croup from the children (Yerushalmi Taanit 4:3).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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להבדיל בין היום ובין הלילה.

מִשֶּׁנִּגְנַז הָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן, אֲבָל בְּשִׁבְעַת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית שִׁמְּשׁוּ הָאוֹר וְהַחֹשֶׁךְ הָרִאשׁוֹנִים יַחַד בֵּין בַּיּוֹם וּבֵין בַּלַּיְלָה:

להבדיל בין היום ובין הלילה *TO CAUSE A DIVISION BETWEEN THE DAY AND THE NIGHT — This took place after the primeval (divine) light was conserved for the righteous;*

but during the first seven [another reading is "three"] days of Creation the primeval light and darkness functioned together both by day and by night.

והיו לאותות.

כְּשֶׁהַמְּאוֹרוֹת לוֹקְיִן, סִימָן רַע הוּא לָעוֹלָם,

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מֵאֹתוֹת הַשָּׁמַיִם אַל תֵּחָתּוּ (ירמיה י'),

בַּעֲשׂוֹתְכֶם רְצוֹן הַקָּבָ"ה אֵין אַתֶּם צְרִיכִין לִדְאֹג מִן הַפֻּרְעָנוּת:

והיו לאותות *AND THEY SHALL BE FOR SIGNS — When the heavenly luminaries are eclipsed it is a sign of ill-omen for the world, as it is written, (Jeremiah 10:2) "Be not dismayed at the signs of heaven" — when you carry out the will of the Holy One, blessed be He, you need apprehend no calamity (Sukkah 29a).*

ולמועדים.

עַל שֵׁם הֶעָתִיד, שֶׁעֲתִידִים יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהִצְטַוּוֹת עַל הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת וְהֵם נִמְנִים לְמוֹלַד הַלְּבָנָה:

ולמועדים *AND FOR SEASONS (FESTIVALS) — This is written with a view to the future when Israel would receive command regarding the festivals which would be calculated from the time of the lunar conjunction (Genesis Rabbah 6:1).*

ולימים.

שִׁמּוּשׁ הַחַמָּה חֲצִי יוֹם וְשִׁמּוּשׁ הַלְּבָנָה חֶצְיוֹ, הֲרֵי יוֹם שָׁלֵם:

ולימים *AND FOR DAYS — The sun functions half a day and the moon the other half — together a full day.*

ושנים.

לְסוֹף שס"ה יָמִים (ס"א וּרְבִיעַ יוֹם), יִגְמְרוּ מַהֲלָכָתָם בְּי"ב מַזָּלוֹת הַמְשָׁרְתִים אוֹתָם, וְהִיא שָׁנָה,

ושנים *AND FOR YEARS — At the end of three hundred and sixty five days [another version:*

365¼] they complete their course through the twelve signs of the Zodiac that attend them, and that is one year [another version:

וְחוֹזְרִים וּמַתְחִילִים פַּעַם שְׁנִיָּה לְסַבֵּב בַּגַּלְגַּל כְּמַהֲלָכָן הָרִאשׁוֹן:

and this makes 365¼ days];

they then begin to revolve a second time in a circle similar to their first cycle.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

והיו למאורת.

עוֹד זֹאת יְשַׁמְּשׁוּ, שֶׁיְּאִירוּ לָעוֹלָם:

והיו למאורות *AND LET THEM BE FOR LIGHTS — They shall serve also this purpose, namely, to give light to the world.*

המארת הגדולים.

שָׁוִים נִבְרְאוּ וְנִתְמַעֲטָה הַלְּבָנָה עַל שֶׁקִּטְרְגָה וְאָמְרָה אִ"אֶ לִשְׁנֵי מְלָכִים שֶׁיִּשְׁתַּמְּשׁוּ בְּכֶתֶר אֶחָד:

המאורות הגדולים *THE GREAT LUMINARIES — They were created of equal size, but that of the moon was diminished because she complained and said, "It is impossible for two kings to make use of one crown" (Chullin 60b).*

ואת הכוכבים.

עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמִּעֵט אֶת הַלְּבָנָה הִרְבָּה צְבָאֵיהָ לְהָפִיס דַּעְתָּהּ:

ואת הכוכבים *AND THE STARS — Because He diminished the moon, He increased its attendant hosts to mollify it (Genesis Rabbah 6:4).*

נפש חיה.

שֶׁיִּהְיֶא בָהּ חַיּוּת:

נפש חיה *LIVING CREATURES — Creatures that shall have vitality.*

שרץ.

כָּל דָּבָר חַי שֶׁאֵינוֹ גָּבוֹהַּ מִן הָאָרֶץ קָרוּי שֶׁרֶץ: בָּעוֹף, כְּגוֹן זְבוּבִים, בַּשְּׁקָצִים, כְּגוֹן נְמָלִים וְחִפּוּשִׁים וְתוֹלָעִים, בַּבְּרִיּוֹת,

שרץ *Every living creature that does not rise much above the ground is called שרץ, e. g., of winged creatures — flies;*

כְּגוֹן חֹלֶד וְעַכְבָּר וְחֹמֶט וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָהֶם, וְכָל הַדָּגִים:

of abominable creatures — ants, beetles and worms;

of larger creatures — the mole, snail and others of the same kind, and all fishes.

התנינם.

דָּגִים גְּדוֹלִים שֶׁבַּיָּם, וּבְדִבְרֵי אַגָּדָה הוּא לִוְיָתָן וּבֶן זוּגוֹ שֶׁבְּרָאָם זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה וְהָרַג אֶת הַנְּקֵבָה וּמְלָחָהּ לַצַּדִּיקִים לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא,

התנינים *THE HUGE CREATURES — the large fishes that are in the sea;*

שֶׁאִם יִפְרוּ וְיִרְבּוּ לֹא יִתְקַיֵּם הָעוֹלָם בִּפְנֵיהֶם:

and according to the statement of the Agada (Bava Batra 74b) it means here the Leviathan and its consort which He created male and female.

He, however, killed the female and preserved it in salt for the benefit of the righteous in the time to come, for had they been permitted to be fruitful and to multiply the world could not have endured because of them.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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נפש החיה.
שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ חַיּוּת:

נפש חיה — *that have vitality.*

ויברך אותם.
לְפִי שֶׁמְּמַחְסְרִים אוֹתָם וְצָדִין מֵהֶם וְאוֹכְלִין אוֹתָם, הֻצְרְכוּ לִבְרָכָה, וְאַף הַחַיּוֹת הֻצְרְכוּ לִבְרָכָה,

ויברך אותם *AND HE BLESSED THEM — Because people decreased their number, hunting them and eating them, they needed a blessing (Genesis Rabbah 11:2);*

אֶלָּא מִפְּנֵי הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁעָתִיד לִקָּלֵלָה, לְכָךְ לֹא בֵּרְכָן, שֶׁלֹּא יְהֵא הוּא בִּכְלָל:

it is true that beasts also were in need of a blessing, but on account of the serpent that was to be cursed in the future, He did not bless them, in order that it might not be included in the blessing.

פרו.
לְ' פְּרִי כְּלוֹ' עֲשׂוּ פֵּרוֹת:

פרו *BE FRUITFUL — פרו is of the same root as פרי, and means bring forth fruit.*

ורבו.
אִם לֹא אָמַר אֶלָּא פְּרוּ, הָיָה אֶחָד מוֹלִיד אֶחָד וְלֹא יוֹתֵר, וּבָא וּרְבוּ שֶׁאֶחָד מוֹלִיד הַרְבֵּה:

ורבו *AND MULTIPLY — Had He said "Be fruitful" only, one creature might have brought forth a single one, and no more, therefore He added ורבו "and multiply", implying that one should bring forth many.*

תוצא הארץ.
הוּא שֶׁפֵּרַשְׁתִּי שֶׁהַכֹּל נִבְרָא מִיּוֹם רִאשׁוֹן, וְלֹא הֻצְרְכוּ אֶלָּא לְהוֹצִיאָם:

תוצא הארץ *THE EARTH SHALL BRING FORTH — That is what I have explained (v. 14) that all things were created on the first day, and it was only necessary to bring them forth from the ground.*

נפש חיה.
שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ חַיּוּת:

נפש חיה — *that have vitality.*

ורמש.
הֵם שְׁרָצִים, שֶׁהֵם נְמוּכִים וְרוֹמְשִׂים עַל הָאָרֶץ וְנִרְאִים כְּאִלּוּ נִגָּרִים שֶׁאֵין הִלּוּכָן נָכֹר.

ורמש — *It means creeping swarms that creep low upon the ground;*

they appear as though they are dragged along, for how they move is not discernible.

כָּל לְשׁוֹן רֶמֶשׂ וְשֶׁרֶץ בִּלְשׁוֹנֵנוּ קונמו"ברישׁ בלע"ז:

What we call רמש and שרץ in our (Hebrew) language, they call in old French mouvoir;

English to move.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

ויעש.

תִּקְּנָם בְּצִבְיוֹנָם וּבְקוֹמָתָן:

ויעש *AND HE MADE — He formed them with their full volition and in their full stature (Chullin 60a).*

נעשה אדם.

עֲנָוְתָנוּתוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּבָ"ה לְמַדְנוּ מִכָּאן,

לְפִי שֶׁאָדָם הוּא בְּדְמוּת הַמַּלְאָכִים וְיִתְקַנְּאוּ בוֹ, לְפִיכָךְ נִמְלַךְ בָּהֶם,

נעשה אדם *WE WILL MAKE MAN — The meekness of the Holy One, blessed be He, they (the Rabbis) learned from here:*

וּכְשֶׁהוּא דָן אֶת הַמְּלָכִים הוּא נִמְלָךְ בְּפָמַלְיָא שֶׁלּוֹ, שֶׁכֵּן מָצִינוּ בְּאַחְאָב,

because the man is in the likeness of the angels and they might envy him, therefore He took counsel with them (Midrash Tanchuma, Shemot 18 and see Genesis Rabbah 8).

שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ מִיכָה רָאִיתִי אֶת ה' יֹשֵׁב עַל כִּסְאוֹ וְכָל צְבָא הַשָּׁמַיִם עוֹמְדִים עָלָיו מִימִינוֹ וּמִשְּׂמֹאלוֹ (מלכים א כ"ב), וְכִי יֵשׁ יָמִין וּשְׂמֹאל לְפָנָיו?

And when He judges the kings He likewise consults His heavenly council, for thus we find in the case of Ahab to whom Micha said, (1 Kings 22:19) "I saw the Lord sitting on His throne, and all the host of heaven standing by Him on His right hand and on His left." Has God, then, a right hand and a left hand?

אֶלָּא אֵלּוּ מַיְמִינִים לִזְכוּת וְאֵלּוּ מַשְׂמְאִילִים לְחוֹבָה,

But it means that some stood on the right side to plead in favour of the accused and others stood on the left side to accuse;

וְכֵן בִּגְזֵרַת עִירִין פִּתְגָמָא וּבְמֵאמַר קַדִּישִׁין שְׁאֵלְתָא (דניאל ד'), אַף כָּאן בְּפָמַלְיָא שֶׁלּוֹ נָטַל רְשׁוּת, אָמַר לָהֶם יֵשׁ בָּעֶלְיוֹנִים כְּדְמוּתִי;

and similarly we read (Daniel 4:14), "the matter is by the decree of the watchers, and the sentence by the word of the holy ones", — here, also, He consulted His heavenly council and asked permission of them, saying to them: "There are in the heavens beings after My likeness;

אִם אֵין כְּדְמוּתִי בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים הֲרֵי יֵשׁ קִנְאָה בְּמַעֲשֶׂה בְרֵאשִׁית:

if there will not be on earth also beings after My likeness, there will be envy among the beings that I have created" (Sanhedrin 38b).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

נעשה אדם.

אַע"פִּ שֶׁלֹּא סִיְּעוּהוּ בִּיצִירָתוֹ וְיֵשׁ מָקוֹם לַמִּינִים לִרְדּוֹת,

נעשה אדם *WE WILL MAKE MAN — Although they did not assist Him in forming him (the man) and although this use of the plural may give the heretics an occasion to rebel (i. e. to argue in favour of their own views), yet the verse does not refrain from teaching proper conduct and the virtue of humbleness, namely, that the greater should consult, and take permission from the smaller;*

לֹא נִמְנַע הַכָּתוּב מִלְּלַמֵּד דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ וּמִדַּת עֲנָוָה שֶׁיְּהֵא הַגָּדוֹל נִמְלָךְ וְנוֹטֵל רְשׁוּת מִן הַקָּטָן; וְאִם כָּתַב אֶעֱשֶׂה אָדָם,

for had it been written, "I shall make man", we could not, then, have learned that He spoke to His judicial council but to Himself.

לֹא לְמַדְנוּ שֶׁיְּהֵא מְדַבֵּר עִם בֵּית דִּינוֹ, אֶלָּא עִם עַצְמוֹ, וּתְשׁוּבַת הַמִּינִים כְּתַב בְּצִדּוֹ, וַיִּבְרָא אֶת הָאָדָם, וְלֹא כָתַב וַיִּבְרְאוּ:

And as a refutation of the heretics it is written immediately after this verse "And God created the man", and it is not written "and they created" (Genesis Rabbah 8:9)

בצלמנו.

בִּדְפוּס שֶׁלָּנוּ:

בצלמנו *IN OUR IMAGE — in our type.*

כדמותנו.

לְהָבִין וּלְהַשְׂכִּיל:

כדמתנו *AFTER OUR LIKENESS — with the power to comprehend and to discern.*

וירדו בדגת הים.

יֵשׁ בַּלָּשׁוֹן הַזֶּה לְשׁוֹן רְדוּי וּלְשׁוֹן יְרִידָה; זָכָה, רוֹדֶה בַּחַיּוֹת וּבַבְּהֵמוֹת, לֹא זָכָה,

נַעֲשֶׂה יָרוּד לִפְנֵיהֶם וְהַחַיָּה מוֹשֶׁלֶת בּוֹ:

וירדו בדגת הים *AND THEY SHALL HAVE DOMINION OVER THE FISH ... [AND OVER THE BEASTS] — The expression* וירדו *may imply dominion as well as descending — if he is worthy he dominates over the beasts and cattle, if he is not worthy he will sink lower than them, and the beast will rule over him (Genesis Rabbah 8:12).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

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Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

ויברא אלקים את האדם בצלמו.

בְּדִפּוּס הֶעָשׂוּי לוֹ, שֶׁהַכֹּל נִבְרָא בְּמַאֲמָר וְהוּא נִבְרָא בַּיָּדַיִם,

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַתָּשֶׁת עָלַי כַּפֶּכָה (תהילים קל"ט);

ויברא אלקים את האדם בצלמו *SO GOD CREATED THE MAN IN HIS IMAGE —in the type that was specially made for him, for everything else was created by a creative fiat, whilst he was brought into existence by a creative act (literally, by hand), as it is said (Psalms 139:5) "And Thou hast laid thy hand upon me." He was made by a seal as a coin that is made by a die that is called in old French coin.*

נַעֲשָׂה בְחוֹתָם כְּמַטְבֵּעַ הֶעָשׂוּיָה עַל יְדֵי רֹשֶׁם שֶׁקּוֹרִין קוי"ן בלע"ז וְכֵן הוּא אוֹמֵר תִּתְהַפֵּךְ כְּחֹמֶר חוֹתָם (איוב ל"ח):

It is similarly said, (Job 38:14) "it is changed as clay under the seal" (Sanhedrin 38a).

בצלם אלקים ברא אותו.

פֵּרֵשׁ לְךָ שֶׁאוֹתוֹ צֶלֶם הַמְתֻקָּן לוֹ, צֶלֶם דְּיוֹקָן יוֹצְרוֹ הוּא:

בצלם אלקים ברא אותו *IN THE IMAGE OF GOD CREATED HE HIM — It explains to you that the form prepared for him was the form of the image of his Creator.*

זכר ונקבה ברא אותם.

וּלְהַלָּן הוּא אוֹמֵר וַיִּקַּח אַחַת מִצַּלְעֹתָיו וגו' (בראשית ב')?

זכר ונקבה ברא אותם *MALE AND FEMALE CREATED HE THEM — And further on (Genesis 2:21) it is said: "and He took one of his ribs etc." (The two passages appear to be contradictory.) But according to a Midrashic explanation, He created him at first with two faces, and afterwards He divided him.*

מִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה שֶׁבְּרָאוֹ שְׁנֵי פַּרְצוּפִים בְּבְרִיאָה רִאשׁוֹנָה, וְאַחַר כָּךְ חָלָקוֹ. וּפְשׁוּטוֹ שֶׁל מִקְרָא,

But the real sense of the verse is:

כָּאן הוֹדִיעֲךָ שֶׁנִּבְרְאוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם בַּשִּׁשִּׁי וְלֹא פִּי' לְךָ כֵּיצַד בְּרִיָּתָן, וּפֵרֵשׁ לְךָ בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר:

here it tells you that both of them were created on the sixth day, but it does not explain to you how their creation took place;

this it explains to you in another place (Genesis Rabbah 8:1 and see Eruvin 18a) .

וכבשה.

חָסֵר וְי"ו לְלַמֶּדְךָ שֶׁהַזָּכָר כּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת הַנְּקֵבָה, שֶׁלֹּא תְהֵא יְצָאנִית,

וכבשה *AND SUBDUE IT — The word lacks a* ו *after the* ש *so that it may be read as meaning:*

וְעוֹד לְלַמֶּדְךָ שֶׁהָאִישׁ שֶׁדַּרְכּוֹ לִכְבֹּשׁ מְצֻוֶּה עַל פְּרִיָּה וּרְבִיָּה וְלֹא הָאִשָּׁה:

and subdue her (i. e. the woman), thereby teaching you that the male controls the female in order that she may not become a gad-about;

teaching you also that to the man, whose nature is to master, was given the Divine command to have issue, and not to the woman (Yevamot 65b).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

לכם יהיה לאכלה ולכל חית הארץ.

הִשְׁוָה לָהֶם בְּהֵמוֹת וְחַיּוֹת לְמַאֲכָל,

וְלֹא הִרְשָׁה לְאָדָם וּלְאִשְׁתּוֹ לְהָמִית בְּרִיָּה וְלֶאֱכֹל בָּשָׂר,

ולכל חית הארץ *AND TO EVERY BEAST OF THE EARTH — Scripture places cattle and beasts on a level with them (human beings:*

אַךְ כָּל יֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב יֹאכְלוּ יַחַד כֻּלָּם,

וּכְשֶׁבָּאוּ בְנֵי נֹחַ הִתִּיר לָהֶם בָּשָׂר,

that is, it places all alike in the same category) with regard to food, and did not permit Adam to kill any creature and eat its flesh, but all alike were to eat herbs.

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כָּל רֶמֶשׂ אֲשֶׁר הוּא חַי וְגוֹ' כְּיֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב שָׁהִתַּרְתִּי לְאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן נָתַתִּי לָכֶם אֶת כֹּל:

But when the era of the "Sons of Noah" began He permitted them to eat meat, for it is said, (Genesis 9:3) "every moving thing that lives should be for food for yourselves ... "even as the herb" that I permitted to the first man, so do "I give to you everything" (Sanhedrin 59b).

יום הששי.

הוֹסִיף ה' בַּשִּׁשִּׁי בְּגִמַּר מַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית, לוֹמַר שֶׁהִתְנָה עִמָּהֶם,

עַל מְנָת שֶׁיְּקַבְּלוּ עֲלֵיהֶם יִשְׂרָאֵל חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה. דָּבָר אַחֵר יוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי,

יום הששי *THE SIXTH DAY — The letter* ה*, the numerical value of which is 5, is added to the word* ששי *when the work of Creation was complete, to imply that He made a stipulation with them that it endures only upon condition that Israel should accept the five books of the Torah (Shabbat 88a).*

כֻּלָּם תְּלוּיִם וְעוֹמְדִים עַד יוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי,

הוּא ו' בְּסִיוָן הַמּוּכָן לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה:

Another interpretation of יום הששי *THE SIXTH DAY — The whole Creation (the Universe) stood in a state of suspense (moral imperfection) until the sixth day — that is, the sixth day of Sivan which was destined to be the day when the Torah would be given to Israel (Avodah Zara 3a).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

ויכל אלקים ביום השביעי.

ר' שִׁמְעוֹן אוֹמֵר בָּשָׂר וָדָם, שֶׁאֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ עִתָּיו וּרְגָעָיו צָרִיךְ לְהוֹסִיף מֵחֹל עַל הַקֹּדֶשׁ, הַקָּבָ"ה שֶׁיּוֹדֵעַ עִתָּיו וּרְגָעָיו, נִכְנַס בּוֹ כְּחוּט הַשַּׂעֲרָה, וְנִרְאֶה כְּאִלּוּ כִלָּה בּוֹ בַּיּוֹם. דְּ"אַ מָה הָיָה הָעוֹלָם חָסֵר? מְנוּחָה, בָּאת שַׁבָּת בָּאת מְנוּחָה, כָּלְתָה וְנִגְמְרָה הַמְּלָאכָה:

ויכל אלקים ביום השביעי *AND ON THE SEVENTH DAY GOD FINISHED — R. Simeon says:*

A human being (literally, flesh and blood) who cannot know exactly his times and moments (who cannot accurately determine the point of time that marks the division between one period and that which follows it) must needs add from the week-day and observe it as the holy day (the Sabbath), but the Holy One, blessed be He, who knows His times and moments, began it (the seventh day) to a very hair's breadth (with extreme exactness) and it therefore appeared as though He had completed His work on that very day (Genesis Rabbah 10:9).

Another explanation:

What did the world lack?

Rest!

Sabbath came — Rest came;

and the work was thus finished and completed (Genesis Rabbah 10:9)!

ויברך, ויקדש.

בֵּרְכוֹ בַּמָּן, שֶׁכָּל יְמוֹת הַשָּׁבוּעַ יוֹרֵד לָהֶם עֹמֶר לַגֻּלְגֹּלֶת, וּבַשִּׁשִּׁי לֶחֶם מִשְׁנֶה, וְקִדְּשׁוֹ בַּמָּן, שֶׁלֹּא יֵרֵד כְּלָל בְּשַׁבָּת, וְהַמִּקְרָא כָּתוּב עַל הֶעָתִיד:

ויברך ... ויקדש *AND GOD BLESSED ... AND HE SANCTIFIED — He blessed it through the Manna, that on all other days of the week there should fall for them (the Israelites) an Omer for each person, whereas on the sixth day there should fall twice as much of that bread.*

So, too, He sanctified it through the Manna, that it should not fall at all on the Sabbath (Genesis Rabbah 11:2).

This verse is written here with reference to what would happen in the future.

אשר ברא אלקים לעשות.

הַמְּלָאכָה שֶׁהָיְתָה רְאוּיָה לֵעָשׂוֹת בַּשַּׁבָּת,

כָּפַל וְעָשָׂאהּ בַּשִּׁשִּׁי כְּמוֹ שֶׁמְּפֹרָשׁ בְּב"ר:

אשר ברא אלקים לעשות *WHICH GOD IN CREATING HAD MADE — The work which should have been done on the Sabbath He did in the double work which He executed on the sixth day, as it is explained in Genesis Rabbah 11:9.*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three windows into Rashi's workshop

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

On Genesis 1:4 — "God saw the light, that it was good" — Rashi does something he rarely does: he stages the pivot in the open. "אף בזה אנו צריכין לדברי אגדה" — here too we need the words of aggadah: God saw the light was unfit for the wicked to use and set it aside for the righteous in the world to come (the Chagigah 12a tradition; Bereshit Rabbah 3:6). Then, without blinking: "ולפי פשוטו כך פרשהו" — and according to its plain sense, explain it thus: He saw that it was good, and it was not fitting for light and darkness to be used in a jumble, so He fixed this one's boundary by day and that one's by night. The aggadah is quoted tight and credited to its genre; the peshat is Rashi's own, and he tells you which is which.

The other spotlights show his compression at work. On 1:6 ("let there be a firmament"), Rashi lifts the midrash's whole cosmology — the heavens created moist on day one, congealed on day two by God's rebuke (Bereshit Rabbah 4:2-3) — and bolts on Job 26:11, "the pillars of heaven tremble," as the prooftext for the rebuke, all in two lines. On 1:8 ("God called the firmament Heaven"), he compresses Chagigah 12a's etymology into a one-liner: שמים as שא מים (bears water), שם מים, and אש ומים — fire and water mixed together. Quoted ingredients, unattributed compression: the sources dissolve into the commentary.

WORD STUDIES

Four words from the aliyah

Four load-bearing words — three Hebrew, one Aramaic from Onkelos — with Klein, Jastrow, and BDB beneath them. The Hebrew three got the full Maagarim sweep (first attestations through the latest, via the Historical Dictionary's own API); the Aramaic via Jastrow/BDB plus a manual CAL lookup (cal.huc.edu prohibits scraping, so two headwords, by hand, no bulk extraction).

אֱלֹקִים

Jastrow · אלקים

— , v. אלוה

Klein · אלקים

m.n. pl.

— God (pl. of majesty).

BDB · אלקים

— n.m.pl. (f. 1 K 11:33; on number of occurrences of אל, אלוה, אלקים cf. also Nesl.c.)

Maagarim

אלקים — 18278 attestations, root אלה 1 (אל).

אלקים opens at the beginning, literally: every first Maagarim citation is Genesis 1:1–3, the verses of this very aliyah — בראשית ברא אלקים — and the whole first page is the creation narrative, twenty-some occurrences deep. Across 775 pages and 18,278 attestations the word is carried overwhelmingly by the biblical corpus. Then it lands in the 1930s: Bialik's

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stories (1930–32) and Yitzhak Shami's ומעה אלאהבל'ג (1937), where אלקים has left the throne room — 'ירחמהו אלקים,' may God have mercy on him, in a villager's mouth, dialect color and piety at once. From the Creator of Genesis 1 to a blessing in a Palestinian village: the divine name's three-thousand-year democratization, with almost nothing in between but the Bible.

שָׁמַיִם

Jastrow · שמים

m.

— du. m. du. (b. h.)

— heaven; trnsf. Heaven, God. Gen. R. s. 1 הש' נבראו תחלה the heaven was first created. Tam. 32ᵃ top מן הש' לארץ וכ' is it farther from heaven to earth, or from east to west? Lam. R. introd. (R. Joh. 1) מרום משמי from

Klein · שמים

m.n. pl.

— visible heavens, sky.

— Heaven, abode of God.

Klein · שמם

— to be desolated; to be appalled.

Maagarim

שמים — 11125 attestations, root שמי 1 (רקיע).

השמים is born in the same three verses — בראשית ברא אלקים את השמים — and the only one of the three that Genesis pauses to define: ויקרא אלקים לרקיע שמים, on day two. Maagarim's 477 pages are a dense biblical core, 11,125 attestations; the word loves formulaic company, paired with אלקים and ארץ across the canon. It lands in Shami's summer — 'העמוקים והכחולים עיניו תקועות בשמי הקיץ,' eyes fixed on the deep blue summer skies — the last several dozen occurrences all coming from ומעה אלאהבל'ג (1937). The firmament that held back the upper waters becomes, in the Hebrew revival, pure landscape: Bialik's 1930s prose is where the heavens stop being cosmology and start being weather.

אמר

Klein · אמר I

BDB · אמר

— vb. utter, say (MI Ph. אמר, Aramaic אמר, Ethiopic I. 2 shew, declare, Arabic command; perhaps אמר orig. = be or make prominent, hence Hithp. infr., אמיר; Sab. אמר lofty, epith. of king JHMordtmZMG 1876,

BDB Aramaic · אמר

— vb. say, tell, command (BH אמר);—

Maagarim

אמר 1 (דיבור, מחשבה) [קל] — 205965 attestations, root אמר 1 (דיבור, מחשבה).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT BERESHIT

What must die, what may be eaten, and the week the world was divided

Sunday, 4 October 2026 · Aliyah 1/7 (Genesis 1:1-2:3) · Daf Bekhorot 16

ויאמר is the most-cited of the three — 205,965 attestations, 6,627 pages, the dictionary's most frequent kal verb — and it opens with the most famous speech-act in the language: יהי אור ויאמר אלקים, the creation formula that fills the entire first page (Genesis 1–3). Divine utterance is the word's first job; every biblical 'and he said' after is an echo. It traverses every genre and millennium as Hebrew's core verb of saying, then lands, beautifully diminished, in 1930s dialogue: 'אמר שיך דבור' — said Sheikh Dabur, pleased with the decision (Shami, 1937). From God speaking light into being to a village sheikh pleased with a decision: the whole democratization of Hebrew in a single verb's journey.

אַרְעָא

Jastrow · ארעא

f.

— (רע, h. q. v.) [the brittle] land, earth, ground, field. Targ. Gen. I, 1. Targ. Y. Gen. XVI, 5; a. fr.—B. Bath. 29ᵃ חדא א׳ one field; v. באגא.—Bekh. 25ᵇ דחשוכא א׳ a land of darkness (Babylon); a. fr.—Sabb. 65ᵃ בת א׳

Jastrow · ארעא

m.

— (ארע I) accident, occurrence. Targ. Ruth II, 3.—[*Pl. ארעייא evils, diseases. Targ. Y. Deut. XXVIII, 60 (prob. to be read מרעיא).]

Klein · ארעא

f.n.

ארעא is Onkelos's steady Aramaic for הארץ — and CAL (s.v. ʾrʿ, ʾrʿʾ) shows why he reaches for it: 'ground; land; Earth,' marked Common Aramaic, at home in every dialect from Old Aramaic (spelled ארק, as in Daniel) through Syriac to Mandaic (arqa). Six sense-groups run ground country the Earth soil floor residue; the plural even switches gender by dialect, feminine in Jewish Literary Aramaic. Its cognate sits in the Hebrew column beside it: ארץ (ʾrṣ against ʾrʕ). There is no journey here, and that is the point: where the Hebrew words travel three millennia, ארעא is everywhere at once — the most universal word for 'earth' in the language family, doing the quiet work of translation.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr